

TUM — Technology Use Boundary Module

Parent Standard: Ethical Layer Standard

Protocol: EVIP® — Ethical Virtual Integrity Protocol

Category: Governance & Enforcement

Subcategory: Technology Use Boundaries

Type: Ethical Validity Module

Version: 1.0

Status: Canonical · Open Module

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Compatibility: OOF® Methodology OS™ · **Ethical Layer Standard** · EVIP® · INTEGROS® · TVL® · UCL™

Authority: OOF®

Protection: MIP® — Methodological Intellectual Property

Canonical Language: English (UCL™)

Canonical Definition

Technology Use Boundary Module defines the structural conditions under which a methodology, system, device, hardware structure, AI environment, autonomous process, or future technology remains within ethically valid boundaries of use.

A system satisfies TUM only if:

- capability remains bounded by ethical legitimacy
- technically possible action is not automatically treated as valid action
- prohibited or invalid use pathways are structurally identifiable
- system design does not normalize boundary violation through convenience, scale, or power
- ethical validity is denied where capability exceeds legitimate use boundaries

A system that treats capability as sufficient justification does not satisfy TUM.

Module Function

TUM defines the ethical boundary between what a system **can** do and what it may **validly** do.

It ensures that no methodology, system, or technology may pass ethical layer conditions if its design, release logic, or operational use extends beyond ethically governed boundaries.

The module applies wherever technical capability creates the possibility of misuse, overreach, coercion, or illegitimate extension of operational power.

Minimum Implementation Framework (MIF)

Step 1 — Define Capability Scope

The organization must define what the system is capable of doing.

Minimum requirement:

- core capabilities are explicit
- operational reach is identifiable
- capability is not treated as undefined or open-ended

Step 2 — Define Valid Use Boundaries

The organization must define the boundary between legitimate and illegitimate use.

Minimum requirement:

- permitted use conditions are explicit
- prohibited or invalid use conditions are identifiable
- ethical validity is not assumed from technical possibility alone

Step 3 — Define Overreach Pathways

The organization must identify where capability may exceed ethical legitimacy.

Minimum requirement:

- misuse, overreach, or coercive pathways are mapped
- expansion beyond intended ethical use is visible
- silent tolerance of excessive capability is excluded

Step 4 — Define Restriction Logic

The system must define how invalid use is restricted.

Minimum requirement:

- restriction conditions are explicit
- invalid pathways are not left open by default
- convenience or efficiency does not override boundary protection

Step 5 — Preserve Legitimacy Over Capability

The system must preserve ethical legitimacy above technical power.

Minimum requirement:

- greater capability does not justify broader use by itself
 - scale does not dissolve boundaries
 - system legitimacy remains subordinate to valid use conditions
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Step 6 — Restrict Invalid Deployment

The system must not be treated as ethically valid if its capability **can** predictably exceed legitimate use boundaries without structural restriction.

Minimum requirement:

- invalid use conditions block ethical passage
 - unbounded capability does not qualify as valid deployment
 - performance alone does not restore legitimacy
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Use Case 1 — Autonomous Surveillance or Monitoring System

Scenario

A technology system is capable of broad monitoring, tracking, inference, or behavioral analysis beyond what is ethically legitimate in the environment where it is deployed.

Application

TUM is used to ensure:

- capability scope is defined
 - valid use boundaries are explicit
 - overreach pathways are identified
 - restriction logic prevents capability from becoming illegitimate operational power
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Result

The organization gains a stronger ethical boundary preventing powerful systems from being treated as valid merely because they are technically effective.

Use Case 2 — Advanced AI or Hardware Capability Expansion

Scenario

An advanced AI or hardware-enabled system gains new operational capability through scaling, optimization, embedded logic, or future upgrade pathways.

Application

TUM is used to ensure:

- the expanding capability is mapped
 - legitimate use boundaries remain explicit
 - new overreach pathways are identified
 - deployment validity is not assumed from technical advancement alone
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Result

The organization gains a stronger ethical gate ensuring that future capability growth remains bounded by legitimacy rather than driven only by possibility.

Canonical Closing Statement

If capability exceeds ethically valid use boundaries, ethical validity has not been achieved.

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Canonical Source

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